

$x_i \in \{\text{True}, \text{False}\} \quad 1 \leq i \leq n$ boolean variables

$x_i, \overline{x_i}$ are literals

C_j : clause $(x_{j,1} \vee x_{j,2} \vee x_{j,3} \dots \vee x_{j,k})$
disjunction of k literals

k -CNF Conjunctive Normal Form with k literals

$(x_{1,1} \vee x_{1,2} \vee \dots \vee x_{1,k}) \wedge (x_{2,1} \vee x_{2,2} \dots x_{2,k}) \wedge \dots \wedge (x_{m,1} \vee \dots \vee x_{m,k})$

Can you satisfy $(x_1 \vee \overline{x}_2) \wedge (\overline{x}_1 \vee \overline{x}_2) \wedge (x_1 \vee x_2)$

Cook Levin Theorem: For any problem $\pi \in \text{NP}$,

there exists a CNF F with at most k literals per clause and a polynomial (in the input size of π)

number of boolean variables and a polynomial number of clauses such that F is satisfiable iff π has an answer Yes

F can be computed in polynomial time.

- Show that 3CNF is NPC -

Given a CNF F with at most k literals per clause, construct a 3CNF F' such that

F is satisfiable $\Leftrightarrow F'$ is satisfiable

Simple observation - If all clauses have 3 literals then there is nothing to do

Let's consider the case where

- consider clauses of size

(i) Two $(x, \vee x_2)$

$$\Leftrightarrow (x, \vee x_2 \vee y) \wedge (x, \vee x_2 \vee \bar{y}) \quad y: \text{new variable}$$

(ii) One $(x_1) \Leftrightarrow$

$$(x_1, \vee y_1, \vee y_2) \wedge (x_1, \vee \bar{y}_1, \vee y_2) \wedge (x_1, \vee y_1, \vee \bar{y}_2) \wedge (x_1, \vee \bar{y}_1, \vee \bar{y}_2)$$

(iii) Three - no action needed y_1, y_2 new variables

(iv) ≥ 4 , say $(x, \vee x_2 \vee x_3 \vee x_4 \vee x_5)$

$$(x, \vee x_2 \vee y_1) \wedge (\bar{y}_1 \vee x_3 \vee y_2) \wedge (\bar{y}_2 \vee x_4 \vee x_5)$$

y_1, y_2 : new additional variables

- Overall for clause of size n , $n-2$ new variables are needed

How many additional variables are needed

- How many clauses are there in the 3CNF

The online transformation is doable by an algorithm in poly-time

Verify that F' is satisfiable $\Leftrightarrow F$ is satisfiable

$$\text{So } L_{\text{SAT}} \leq^{\text{poly}} L_{\text{3SAT}}$$

$\Rightarrow$ For any $\pi \in \text{NP}$

$$\pi \leq^{\text{poly}} L_{\text{SAT}} \leq^{\text{poly}} L_{\text{3SAT}}$$

$$\Rightarrow \pi \leq^{\text{poly}} L_{\text{3SAT}} \Rightarrow L_{\text{3SAT}} \text{ is NP-hard}$$

Is $L_{\text{3SAT}} \in \text{NP}$?

L_{VC} : the set of strings that
are YES instances of Vertex Cover

Is L_{VC} NPC?

(i) $L_{VC} \in NP$

(ii) Some NPC $\leq^{poly} L_{VC}$?

Consider 3SAT formula $x_{ij} \in \{x_i, \bar{x}_i, x_j, \bar{x}_j, \dots, x_n, \bar{x}_n\}$

$$F = (x_{11} \vee x_{12} \vee x_{13}) \wedge (x_{21} \vee x_{22} \vee x_{23}) \dots (x_{m1} \vee x_{m2} \vee x_{m3})$$

We want to construct an instance of V.C.

$$J = (V, E, K) \quad 1 \leq K \leq |V|$$

such that F is satisfiable $\Leftrightarrow J$ is a Yes instance

(without knowing if F is satisfiable!)

Claim F is satisfiable iff $\mathcal{V}(F)$ has a VC of size n

(1) F is satisfiable $\Rightarrow$ At least one literal is true in every clause

Choose the remaining two (break ties or arbitrarily) in the subset W

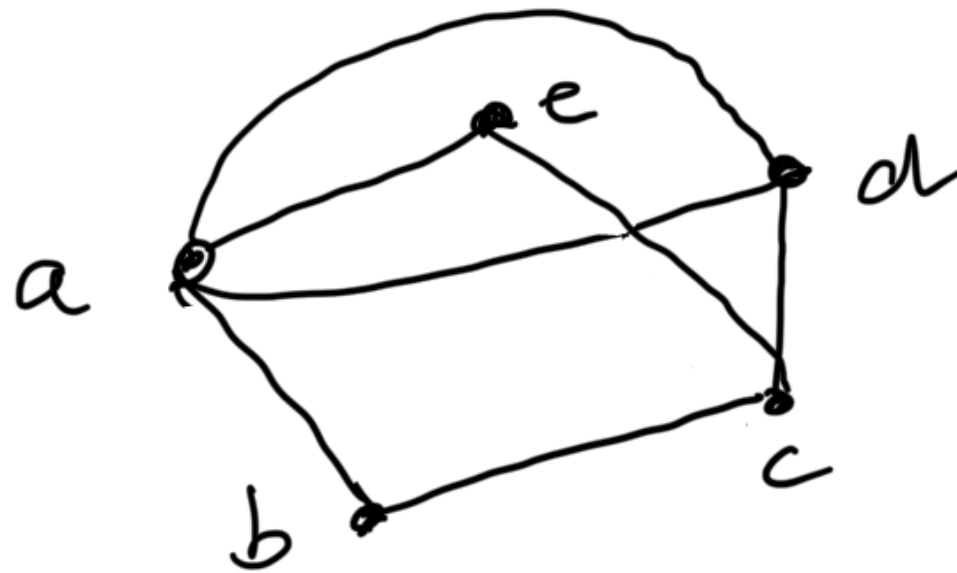
W is a vertex cover of size $2m$

(2) $\mathcal{V}(F)$ has a VC of size $2m \Rightarrow F$ is satisfiable

Truth assignment: Choose the variable in a Δ not in VC to be True. Show this is a consistent assignment

How do we tackle hard problems that cannot be avoided?

Consider the problem of minimum Vertex Cover



① Find a maximal matching

② $W =$ set of endpoints of matching edges

Claim : (i) W is a vertex cover

(ii) $|W| \leq 2 \cdot |O^*|$ $O^* : \text{min VC}$

Other important complexity classes

$co-NP$: complement of NP

$PSPACE$: Polynomial Space

RP , NP , BPP , PP : probabilistic classes
(for randomized algorithms)